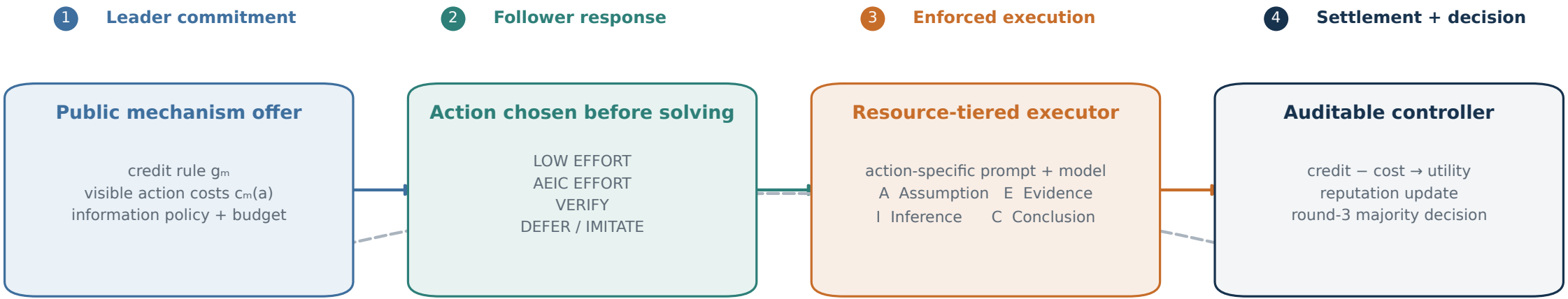
AEIC mechanism: observable effort before aggregation

The leader commits first; each follower chooses an action that selects a real execution path before settlement.



Empirical evidence chain

Formal test	→ Follower response	→ Decision effect	→ Boundary
450 paired questions 3 QA domains	+56.47 pp high effort 0.46% → 56.93%	+14.22 pp accuracy Holm $p = 1.23\times10^{-11}$	outcome-only: null held-out GLM: null

Scope: revealed-rule follower response on tested backends; no claim of universal incentive compatibility, equilibrium, or cross-backend transfer.